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Aided by Eyes High in the Sky
Ukrainian drone teams have a powerful new tool: near real-time data from satellites on troop movements and locations. Page A8.

Post-Pandemic Supreme Court Has More to Say

By ADAM LIPTAK
On about 40 mornings each year, the justices take their seats behind the Supreme Court’s majestic mahogany bench to hear oral arguments.
Part interrogation of the lawyers before them and part conversation among the justices, those sessions are not as important as the written briefs submitted by the parties. But the arguments that follow those submissions are essentially the only way the public can see the court at work.
The ritual had hardly changed in 50 years until the spring of 2020, when the pandemic ousted the

Oral Arguments Stretch Much Longer Since Change in Format

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He will inevitably call Shine-Erkh Picon, his assistant, with a list of reporters, academics and elected officials he wants to contact. He will inevitably bristle when his missives are not received with the enthusiasm (or responses) they so richly deserve.
This was one of those instances. For several years, Mr. Nader, 92, has been trying to get anyone — reporters, state lawmakers, Mayor Zohran Mamdani of New York City — to take up the fight to bring back a stock transfer tax that existed in New York State for about 80 years until 1981, when Gov. Hugh L. Carey ushered through a 100 percent rebate.
Even in a moment when taxing the rich is all the rage, a bill to repeal the rebate has gone nowhere in Albany. In many ways, the quest for a stock transfer tax en-

ceremony. When the justices returned to the bench in October 2021, their approach to oral arguments had undergone a revolution. The aftershocks are still reverberating.
The justices allowed live audio of the arguments, letting the public hear what went on in the courtroom in real time from anywhere in the world.
They also revised the format of the arguments, adopting an ungainly hybrid that started with a familiar free-for-all barrage of questions and ended with one-by-one queries in order of the justices’ seniority.
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CLODAGH KILCOYNE FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Future Champions Battling Shifting Sands
An uninhabited Irish island fills up one day each summer for treasured amateur races. Page A4.

Start of Shakur Murder Trial Revisits Gang Wars

By JULIA JACOBS and THOMAS FULLER
Three decades after the murder of Tupac Shakur, the hip-hop legend gunned down in the prime of his career, the trial of the only person ever to be charged in connection with the killing began in a Nevada courtroom on Monday.
Duane Keith Davis, whose memoir of gangland stories is being used against him in the case,

Lawyer Calls Suspect’s Memoir Unreliable

was described as responsible for the “orchestration” of Mr. Shakur’s killing on the night of Sept. 7, 1996.
Binu Palal, the prosecutor, told jurors in the Las Vegas courtroom that Mr. Shakur’s murder

stemmed from a series of gang-related grievances and counter-grievances including an “act of disrespect”: the yanking of a gold chain from a man’s neck at a Los Angeles shopping mall.
Mr. Davis was charged three
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AT THE SCENE The people who were present on the night of the fatal confrontation in 1996. PAGE C1

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China is offering more than A.I. models. It wants its data to influence the world’s chatbots, raising fears that Beijing’s narratives will spread. PAGE A6
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President Trump’s son-in-law went to Jerusalem to try to break a logjam over plans for the future of Gaza. PAGE A5
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Silicon Valley parents are wary of tech, setting strict digital boundaries. Maybe they’re onto something. PAGE B1


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Cinco, above, roves the Arizona mountains and has about everything he needs — except a mate. PAGE D1
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Experts say the screenings are not ready to help predict whether healthy people will develop dementia. PAGE D7

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Louisiana’s new surgeon general is emphasizing wellness and prevention while also aligning with MAHA in fighting government mandates. PAGE A9
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Three primaries on Tuesday pose a test for the left in a state where socialism is often seen as a dirty word. PAGE A10
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Buster Posey is finding that running the Giants is harder for him than catching was. And fans are angry. PAGE B6

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A journalist’s renewed curiosity about who informed on family members swept up by the Nazis in Belgium has become a dispute over who has a right to tell their story, and how. PAGE C1
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The 2002 abduction of Elizabeth Smart became a national story. In a new podcast, she speaks to crime victims about what they endured and the lengthy healing process. PAGE C1
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Star of ‘Nashville’ and ‘Heroes’
Hayden Panettiere’s career began when she was 11 months old, and she later struggled with depression and substance abuse. She was 36. PAGE B10


NEWS ANALYSIS

Trump Speaks Fondly of Kim, Rattling Seoul

Ties With South Tested Amid Push to Cut Drills

By CHOE SANG-HUN
SEOUL — The South Korean and United States militaries view their annual drills in South Korea as more critical than ever. The stakes have risen dramatically as South Korea has gained battlefield expertise with drones and modern warfare by deploying troops to support Russia’s war in Ukraine.
The summer exercise had barely begun on Monday when President Trump denounced it, dealing yet another blow to the seven-decade alliance between Washington and Seoul. Under Mr. Trump, bilateral relations have already come under immense strain from his punishing tariffs on South Korean exports. And his transactional diplomacy has frustrated South Korea, most recently when he appeared to put Saudi Arabia on the path to enriching nuclear fuel on its own soil, a demand Seoul has made for years.
In recent years, North Korea has not only expanded its nuclear arsenal but also repeatedly threatened to use it against South Korea, labeling its neighbor a “most hostile enemy.” The North’s leader, Kim Jong-un, has also forged a mutual defense treaty with Moscow, sending troops and weapons to support Russia’s war against Ukraine.
Despite these escalations, Mr. Trump, in a social media post, characterized North Korea as “unthreatening and respectful” while boasting of his “very good relationship” with Mr. Kim.
In the same post, he also criticized the decades-old joint military drills with South Korea as “not only costly” but “totally inappropriate and hostile” toward North Korea.
“I am not happy with the fact that the United States has, long ago, agreed to participate in Joint Military Exercises with South Korea,” he said. “Based on the fact that it is too late to cancel, I have instructed Secretary of War, Pete Hegseth, to substantially reduce the Joint Military Exercises!”
If carried out, the directive would be Mr. Trump’s first-known concrete overture toward North Korea in his second term. However, it remains unclear whether Mr. Kim will embrace the gesture.
Throughout his political career, Mr. Trump has treated the alli-

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THWARTED TRUMP THREATENS OMAN AS TRUCE EXPIRES

AN ALLY AND MEDIATOR

U.S. Vows Sanctions on Iran, and to Maintain Blockade in Strait

By LUKE BROADWATER
WASHINGTON — As a crumbling truce with Iran officially collapsed on Monday, President Trump signaled his frustration at his inability to resolve a war that he started but cannot seem to end.
In an interview with Fox News, the president lashed out at an American ally, Oman, that has been trying to mediate negotiations with Iran.
“If Oman gets in the way, we’ll bomb the shit out of them,” Mr. Trump said in a phone interview, according to Fox News’s Trey Yingst.
The latest threat toward Oman, which has facilitated talks between the United States and Iran for years and maintains that it is still a neutral mediator, came as Mr. Trump found himself without much leverage to reach the goals he set out at the start of the war.
“I think, ultimately, his threats against Oman are just a reflection of his frustration with the situation he’s created, where he has no good options,” said Nate Swanson, of the Atlantic Council’s Iran Strategy Project. “He’s just reflexively lashing out, and this time Oman got in the cross hairs.”
When the conflict began in February, administration officials pledged that it would be over in four to six weeks.
On the battlefield, the United States has struck thousands of targets in Iran and dealt serious blows to the country’s military capabilities, but the president has struggled to achieve the war’s political objectives.
In June, the two sides agreed to a memorandum of understanding, but that quickly fell apart. Both Mr. Trump and Iran’s leaders have said the deal is essentially dead.
“It is mostly symbolic, but symbols matter,” Justin Logan, the director of defense and foreign policy studies at the Cato Institute, said of the expiration of the memorandum of understanding. He emphasized that the main function of the agreement was to reopen the Strait of Hormuz, the shipping lane in the Persian Gulf that Iran effectively closed during the war.
“The tragic part here is that the United States is clawing to try to get back to the state of the Middle East before the war started,” he said.
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At 92, Nader Is Still Asking You to Listen

By BENJAMIN ORESKES
Each day, nearly without fail, Ralph Nader inhales several prominent periodicals, breathing new life into his perpetual state of outrage at the political environment du jour.
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For African Priests in Italy, a Tentative Embrace

By MOTOKO RICH and JOSEPHINE DE LA BRUYÈRE
VERNIO, Italy — The priest stepped into the bedroom where his 90-year-old parishioner lay sleeping in a hospital bed, flanked by oxygen tanks. The pastor towered over the bed and leaned down to move close to the patient, Carlo Martini, as the old man’s eyes fluttered open briefly.
“How are you?” the priest, the Rev. Vincent Souly, asked, a bit too loudly.
Mr. Martini’s wife, Renza Giagnoni, stood to the side and watched. “It looks like we’re the United Nations!” she said, also a bit too loudly.
Father Souly is one of the few Black faces in the province of Prato, a mountainous region of Tuscany in central Italy, where he has served for 15 years as a Roman Catholic priest.
He has built warm relationships with his predominantly Italian flocks and is embraced by many



ALESSANDRO GRASSANI FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

The Rev. Vincent Souly leads several rural parishes in Tuscany.

parishioners. Born in Burkina Faso and raised and ordained in Ivory Coast, he is now an Italian citizen and is committed to staying in Prato as long as he is needed.
Yet, he said, his Italian passport

does not necessarily make others see him as Italian.
“Where I’m from, we say, ‘A piece of wood, no matter how long it stays in water, will never be-
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